

Meatloaf Sandwich

Free-form glazed meatloaf · max-crisp oven fries · A1 aioli · ~4 sandwiches

YIELD	ACTIVE	MEATLOAF	FRIES
~4 sandwiches	~2 hr	350°F → 160°F	450°F

MEATLOAF

907 g beef (85/15) · free-form on a rack · 160°F internal

MEAT & BINDER		AROMATICS		SEASONINGS	
Ground beef 85/15	907 g	Onion diced	100 g	Salt	10 g
Breadcrumbs	80 g	Garlic minced	6 g	Black pepper	3 g
Milk	80 g	Butter / oil	10 g	Garlic powder	12 g
Eggs (2)	100 g	Soy sauce	15 g	Onion powder	16 g
Ketchup glaze	120 g	Worcestershire	10 g	Paprika	4 g
		Fish sauce	5 g	Thyme	1 g
		Tomato paste	10 g	Oregano	1 g
		Brown sugar	15 g		

- 1

Base: preheat **350°F**. Sauté onion + garlic in butter until soft; add tomato paste, cook 1 min, cool. Whisk eggs, milk, soy, Worcestershire, fish sauce.
- 2

Bind: add breadcrumbs + all seasonings + brown sugar to the egg mix, rest **5 min**, then add beef + aromatics and mix firmly to bind.
- 3

Shape: line a loaf pan with plastic wrap, pack tight, flip onto a **rack-on-sheet**, peel the wrap. Bake **45–50 min**.
- 4

Glaze: coat with ketchup, bake **15 min more to 160°F internal**, then **rest 10 min** before slicing.

Resting is non-negotiable — slice it straight out of the oven and the juices run out into a dry, crumbly mess. Ten minutes lets them redistribute. The **rack-on-sheet + free-form** shape (vs. baked in the pan) lets all sides brown and the fat drain instead of stewing.

The Fries

MAX CRISP FRIES

4 russets · soak overnight · 450°F on preheated pans

Russet potatoes	4	Neutral oil split	30 g
(700–800 g)	—	Baking soda in parboil water	3 g
Rice flour	8 g	Salt in parboil water	10 g
Cornstarch	8 g		

- 1 Soak:** cut $\frac{1}{4}$ " fries, soak overnight. Parboil in salted + baking-soda water **2–3 min**, drain, steam-dry **5 min**.
- 2 Coat:** preheat **450°F with two sheet pans inside**. Dust the fries with rice flour + cornstarch, toss with **15 g oil**, spread on the hot pans.
- 3 Bake:** **20 min**, then flip, add the remaining oil, swap pan positions, bake **20–25 min** more. Optional broil **2 min**. Season immediately.

Two tricks do the crisping. The **overnight soak** rinses surface starch so the exterior shatters instead of gumming; the **baking soda** in the parboil raises pH, breaking down pectin for a fluffy interior. Preheated pans give the bottoms an instant sear — cold pans steam.

FRY SEASONING

~115 g batch — use 55–60 g, save the rest

Paprika	30 g	Salt Diamond Crystal, by wt	24 g
Garlic powder	20 g	Sugar	6 g
Onion powder	16 g	Cayenne	2 g
Black pepper 16-mesh	10 g	Oregano	2 g
Mustard powder	1 g		

Build the Sandwich

A1 AIOLI

Doubled batch — raw + roasted garlic for depth

Mayonnaise	240 g	Lemon juice	10 g
A1 steak sauce	100 g	Worcestershire	6 g
Dijon mustard	24 g	Black pepper	2 g
Garlic 12 g roast, 12 g raw	24 g	Cayenne / hot sauce	to taste

Roast half the garlic until golden, mash both roasted and raw to a paste, whisk with everything else, chill 30 min. All raw is too sharp; all roasted too mellow — the mix is the point.

SAUTÉED ONIONS

Low and slow — rushing steams them, never caramelizes

Yellow onion sliced thin	150 g	Salt	1 g
Butter	10 g	Black pepper	0.5 g
Olive oil	10 g	Worcestershire / balsamic	3 g

Cook in butter + oil over low heat until **deep golden — 20–30 min**, stirring occasionally (color is the target, not the clock). Finish with the Worcestershire or balsamic.

ASSEMBLY

Per sandwich · ~4 total

Sourdough / round loaf	2 slices	Cheese provolone / cheddar	30–40 g
A1 aioli	25–30 g	Sautéed onions	75 g
Meatloaf 1 thick slice	160–200 g	Arugula, pickles optional	—

- 1 Melt:** toast the bread lightly; warm a meatloaf slice, top with cheese, melt under the broiler.
- 2 Close:** spread aioli on both slices, layer meatloaf + cheese, onions, and extras; close, slice, serve with the fries.

Run of Show

COOKING TIMELINE

~2 hr from aioli to plate

TIME	ACTION
T-30 min	Start aioli: roast half the garlic, mash with raw, mix with the rest, chill.
T-20 min	Slice onions thin; start them low and slow in butter + oil.
T-0	Preheat oven 350°F. Mix and shape the meatloaf. Into the oven.
T+30 min	Check onions (keep going); check meatloaf.
T+45-50	Glaze meatloaf with ketchup; return to oven.
T+60-65	Meatloaf done at 160°F. Pull and rest 10–15 min.
While resting	Parboil fries in salted + baking-soda water 2–3 min; drain, steam-dry.
T+70 min	Preheat oven 450°F with 2 pans inside. Dust fries with flour + starch, toss with oil, spread on the hot pans. Bake 20 min.
T+90 min	Flip fries, drizzle remaining oil, swap pan positions. Bake 20–25 min more (optional broil 2 min).
Last 10 min	Toast bread. Warm meatloaf slices. Melt cheese on the meatloaf.
T+115 min	Season fries HOT. Assemble: aioli both slices, meatloaf + cheese, onions, extras. Serve immediately.

Fries: the overnight soak removes surface starch for a crispier result; baking soda in the parboil raises pH and breaks down pectin for a fluffier interior. **Meatloaf:** resting is critical — slice too early and it's a dry, crumbly mess. **Aioli:** raw + roasted garlic gives depth; all raw is too sharp, all roasted too mellow. **Onions:** low and slow — rush them and you get steamed onions, not caramelized.